Helical Insight version 5.2 supports six additional databases

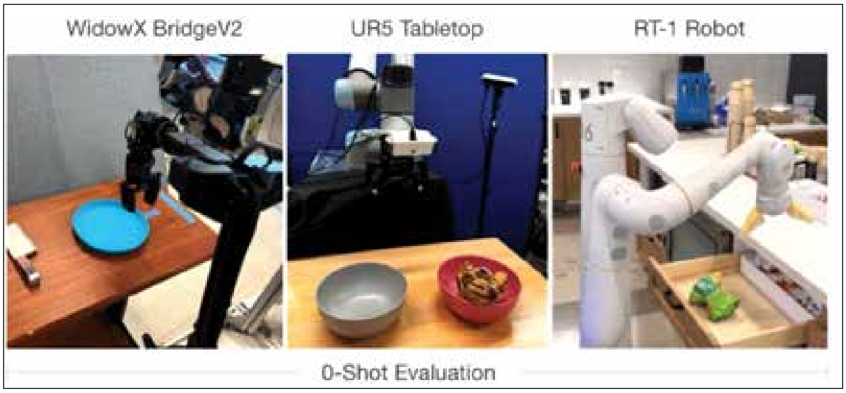
Helical Insight has introduced version 5.2 (5.2.0.1473 GA) of its business intelligence (BI) product. The new version adds support for six additional databases: SAP HANA, CelerData, CockroachDB, DuckDB, Firebird SQL, and Yugabyte. The new import-export utility allows users to transfer files between servers, supporting the transfer of specific folders or entire file browsers. Similar to Windows operations, users can now cut, copy, and paste resources within the Helical Insight file browser. A recycle bin feature enables admins to recover or permanently delete resources like data sources, reports, dashboards, folders, and users, also allowing for ownership level changes. Version 5.2 introduces a visualisation framework (VF) that integrates external JS visualisations such as AntD charts and muzeJS charts, enhancing the flexibility of visualisations within Helical Insight.

It now includes map support with Mapbox, featuring drill down, drill through, exporting, inter-panel communication, and various customisation options like colour and size adjustments.

The future roadmap includes integrating generative AI for advanced *ad hoc* analytics through a chat interface, re-introducing canned report modules for pixel-perfect multi-page reports, migrating to higher LTS versions of Java and Tomcat, and continuing support for additional data sources, new charts, and customisation options.

Octo, the generalist model for robotic manipulation

Researchers at the University of California, Berkeley (UC Berkeley), Stanford University, and Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) have introduced Octo, an open source generalist model for robotic manipulation. Octo is designed to enable various robotic systems to manipulate a wide range of objects effectively. This model, detailed in a pre-published paper on *arXiv*, aims to advance the development of robots capable of performing diverse manual tasks.



The team's objectives were twofold: to develop a versatile generalist robotics model applicable to various robots and to create open source code enabling other researchers to build similar models in the future.

Octo is based on transformers, the same type of neural networks used in ChatGPT. The model was trained on the largest dataset of robotic manipulation trajectories compiled to date, the Open X-Embodiment dataset. Octo can process a diverse range of sensory inputs, including different types of images, robot joint readings, language instructions, and goal-related images.

"Octo is what we call a 'generalist' robot model, a neural network that can control many different types of robots and make them fulfil requests like 'pick up the spoon', 'close the drawer', 'wipe the table', etc," the researchers Dibya Ghosh, Homer Walke, Karl Pertsch, Kevin Black, and Oier Mees explained. "Being a generalist and working on many robots is key, because if you look at research labs around the world, many of them use different robots, so the only way to ensure Octo can be used by many researchers is by supporting a wide range of robots."

"We want to build similar foundation models, but for robot control, or in other words, models that can control many robots and make them solve many different tasks," the researchers stated. "Octo is a first step towards that goal. Its training looks very similar to models like ChatGPT: we curate a large and diverse dataset, in our case robot data instead of text, and train a large model to predict the next action the robot should execute given the current robot state and a task instruction."

Support for Raspberry Pi 5 included in AlmaLinux

The Raspberry Pi 5 boasts impressive specifications for a single-board computer. It features a Broadcom BCM2717 2.4GHz quad-core 64-bit ARM Cortex-A76 CPU, equipped with 512KB per core L2 caches and a shared 2MB L3 cache. Additionally, the board is outfitted with a VideoCore VII GPU, supporting OpenGL ES 3.1 and Vulkan 1.2, making it a robust option.

Previously, AlmaLinux did not support Raspberry Pi 5, but that limitation has been overcome. Both AlmaLinux 9.4 and 8.10 are now compatible with the device. This popular Linux distribution is now available for the Raspberry Pi 5, as well as the Raspberry Pi 4, Raspberry Pi 400, and Raspberry Pi 3 families.